

Deposition of Tessa Wynn — appearance and work history

Q. Please state your position and the date of your testimony.

A. I am an audit manager at Blue Cedar Compliance, Inc. I am testifying on October 2, 2025. I worked in the same operations group as Leora Benton, Omar Ibarra, and Calvin Keene during the 2025 reduction in force, and Naomi Voss supervised us.

Q. How long have you held that role?

A. I became an audit manager in 2021. My work includes planning regulated-client audits, assigning field personnel, reviewing findings, coordinating remediation, and communicating with clients during transitions. The four managers had different portfolios, but we used the same job framework and shared a field-auditor pool.

Q. Did you make the final reduction-in-force decision?

A. No. I did not attend the calibration meetings and did not score Benton or any other manager. I learned that I was retained after the decision was made. I can describe my work, records shown to me, and conversations about assignments, but I cannot testify from personal knowledge about everything Pike considered when he approved the final scenario.

Duties shared with Benton

Q. What functions did you and Benton both perform?

A. We both prepared engagement plans, assigned field teams, reviewed exception reports, followed remediation work, and gave client status updates. We could cover one another when someone was unavailable. Benton also chaired the remediation-quality meeting, while I had responsibility for several client transitions. Those special assignments did not place us in separate departments.

Q. Were your duties identical in every respect?

A. No. Our client lists and current projects differed. I was the named transition owner for Lantern in early 2025. Benton was responsible for Northline and Oriole and had more responsibility for the quality-review process. But the same manager job description covered our common work.

Q. Could another manager receive a client transition?

A. Yes, with a handoff. It might require calls, file review, and extra hours, but reassignment was possible. After Benton left, I took Northline while retaining Lantern. Ibarra took Oriole, and Keene received the remediation queue.

Lead-credit records and project roles

Q. Were you familiar with the disagreement about recorded lead credit?

A. I knew Benton believed the lead field did not always match the person doing planning or field work. Managers sometimes divided responsibilities across phases, while one person remained in the database as the engagement lead. I did not decide how the company used that field in annual reviews.

Q. Explain the Lantern roles reflected in the records.

A. Calvin Keene held the recorded engagement-lead designation for the earlier audit work. Benton prepared portions of the control map and led a remediation conference. I later became the owner of the client transition expected to finish in May 2025. Those are different roles and time periods, so the lead entry and my later transition ownership can both be accurate.

Q. What about Juniper?

A. I received the recorded lead designation after Benton prepared the risk plan and client presentation. I understood Benton's concern to be that the formal label could obscure substantial work by someone else. I did not view her January request as accusing me personally of misconduct.

Completion, travel, and credentials

Q. What did your 2024 source metrics show?

A. I closed thirty-eight of forty-three audits on time. I completed nineteen approved travel days. My imported RIF values were 24 for completion, 20 for continuity, 12 for credentials, 10 for availability, and 10 for role uniqueness. Those values totaled 76.

Q. How did that compare with Benton?

A. The records shown to me list Benton at forty-seven of fifty timely audits and twenty-eight travel days. Her imported total was 84. She held an internal-auditor credential and a regulatory-controls credential. I do not recall any discipline or failed regulatory deliverable for her.

Q. Did your scorecard contain a discipline entry or an employee-relations deduction?

A. No. My card recorded no discipline and no employee-relations field. It focused on the five written criteria. I was not asked to verify Benton's availability reduction, and I did not supply information about the December assignment she declined. My testimony about those values comes from the scorecards produced in this case.

Lantern transition and continuity evidence

Q. Describe the Lantern transition.

A. It was scheduled to finish on May 30, 2025. I coordinated open remediation items, client contacts, and the final transfer of supporting files. The work mattered to the client, and I expected several calls during April and May. The transition record did not contain a written client demand that I personally remain through completion.

Q. Did the client threaten to leave if another manager took over?

A. Not in any communication I saw. Management described Lantern as relationship sensitive. I understood that to mean continuity was desirable, not that reassignment was impossible. Managers regularly tried to avoid unnecessary changes during a transition.

Q. How did Lantern compare in timing with Benton's matters?

A. Northline was scheduled through June 18 and Oriole through June 27. Both extended beyond Lantern. I did not create the written scale, but I understand that transitions extending farther beyond the planned April payroll date ordinarily received more continuity consideration. The records show that my continuity points nevertheless increased while Benton's decreased.

Continuity adjustment and scorecard approval

Q. What happened to your continuity score?

A. It increased from 20 to 22, raising my final total from 76 to 78. The exception was approved on March 10 and referred to keeping one owner through Lantern. I did not request a specific number of points and was not present when the calibration group decided on the increase.

Q. Did you provide a different transition scale for Benton?

A. No. I did not evaluate Northline or Oriole for scoring purposes. I knew those matters could be handed off with work, but I also knew they continued later than Lantern. Voss and operations made the scoring judgments reflected in the workbook.

Q. Were you told that the lowest score mechanically controlled retention?

A. No. My understanding was that management considered weighted scores, payroll savings, and coverage. I later learned several savings combinations met the target. I was retained in the combination Pike approved, but I did not compare or vote on those alternatives. My testimony is limited to the exception on my card and the assignments I performed.

Early-March contingency coverage

Q. Did Voss ask whether you could cover Northline if staffing changed?

A. Yes. In early March she asked whether I could take Northline if a manager position were removed. I said I could do it, although I would need the client history and additional transition time because Lantern was still active. I understood the question as contingency coverage rather than a final assignment.

Q. Did that conversation make you part of the selection decision?

A. No. I was not shown the manager scores or the savings scenarios then. Voss did not ask me to recommend Benton or another manager for termination. I answered only whether I could perform the work if management changed the staffing arrangement.

Q. Did you receive Northline at that time?

A. No. Benton remained responsible for it until her employment ended. The actual transfer came through Voss's March 25 message. Before then I did not contact the client as its new manager or change its file ownership. The early conversation was preparation for a possibility, not a completed reassignment.

Post-RIF assignment of Northline

Q. What happened after Benton's termination?

A. Voss assigned Northline to me on March 25. I reviewed Benton's documentation, joined transition calls, and continued managing Lantern. Benton's files were organized and ready for transfer. I did not find a quality problem that prevented me from using her work.

Q. Was Northline discontinued?

A. No. The engagement and remediation transition continued. I became the listed manager, but the underlying client function remained active through the June handoff. I had additional management hours during the overlap with Lantern.

Q. Did Blue Cedar hire a replacement for Benton's title?

A. Not during the period reflected in the post-RIF organization records. Her work was divided among the three retained managers and Voss. By May 31, the transferred matters were still active. My taking Northline showed that a handoff could occur; it did not tell me why management had chosen Benton rather than a different manager or what legal conclusion should follow from the choice.

Calibration knowledge and decision authority

Q. Did you attend the March 4, March 7, March 10, or March 14 calibration meetings?

A. No. I did not see the minutes until they were produced in this case. I did not hear Pike's discussion of the alternatives and did not know at the time that Benton's score had fallen from 84 to 68.

Q. Did Pike tell you his reason for choosing the final scenario?

A. No. I received staffing instructions from Voss after approval. I knew the company was reducing costs, but Pike did not explain to me how he weighed salary, continuity, travel, automation, or the score variances.

Q. Can you testify that your continuity exception was the true reason Benton was selected?

A. No. I can testify that the exception existed, that Lantern ended May 30, and that I later took Northline. I cannot supply Pike's state of mind. I also cannot say the managers were identical. My comparison is that we performed overlapping work within the same calibration group and were evaluated through the same five named criteria.

Disclosed subjects and transcript review

Q. What subjects were you prepared to address today?

A. My duties, source metrics, calibration score, continuity exception, and the assignments I retained or received after the reduction in force. Those are the subjects identified for me in the August 15 disclosures. I reviewed the common job description, scorecard, Lantern schedule, workbook entries, and March 25 assignment message for that purpose.

Q. Have your answers distinguished records from personal observation?

A. Yes. I personally performed the work and participated in the assignment conversations I described. I learned the exact scores, meeting dates, and alternative-scenario details from documents shown to me. I did not attend the calibration meetings and have not claimed personal knowledge of Pike's complete reasoning.

Q. Do you have any correction now?

A. I initially said Lantern's transition ended "at the end of April." The schedule says May 30, and May 30 is correct. I make no other correction at this time. I will review the transcript under the applicable procedure, and I understand that a materially different discoverable-information subject would have to be addressed separately from the subjects examined today.